



TIPS & TRICKS



Setting the tab in Vim

Normally, you should set your tab space value to four spaces while doing programming. By default, this value will be eight spaces. Here are the steps to customise the tab space value in your favourite Vim editor:

```
$ sudo vim /etc/vim/vimrc
```

Then add the following line:

```
set tabstop=4
```

Next, save, exit and execute the script, as follows:

```
$ bash
```

Now when you check, your tab space will be set to 4 in Vim.

—Dibyendu Roy,
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Disabling USB in Linux

There are various ways by which you can disable a USB mass storage device. Here is how you can disable a USB device by editing *grub.conf* or *menu.lst*. All you need to do is open the file in a text editor and append *nousb* as one of the kernel parameters:

```
kernel /vmlinuz-2.6.18-128.1.1.el5 ro root=LABEL=/  
console=tty0 console=ttyS1,19200n8 nousb
```

Save and close the file and reboot the system to make the changes effective:

```
# reboot
```

—Ajinkya Jiman,
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Missing the shutdown option?

If you could not find the 'Shutdown' option on your PC that is running GNOME 3 as the desktop environment,

just press the ALT key and see your favourite shutdown option in the system menu.

—Karthikeyan,
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Recovering a recently opened deleted file

By using *lsyf*, you can recover a deleted file that was opened already. This comes very handy when an attacker gains access to the system and has executed commands or has done some configuration changes, and then removes the log file(s) to erase evidence. A sysadmin can use this method to recover the file which has been opened by some processes to check what all the hacker has changed.

The *lsyf - list open file* is the command used for this:

```
lsyf | grep "syslog" ( List processes which has this file  
opened )
```

```
rsyslogd 990 root 1w REG 8,3  
141400 1237857 /var/log/syslog
```

Here the process 990 (PID) has opened the file '/var/log/syslog' with file descriptor as '1' (1w)

To recover the content of the file, just run the following command:

```
cat /proc/990/fd/1 > syslog.safe
```

You will have the content of the file stored in *syslog.safe*

—Lakshmanan Ganapathy,
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Securing a directory

Here is a tip that uses the *sticky bit* feature of Linux to secure a directory. A sticky bit ensures that no user other than the owner and the super user can delete files in the directory. When a sticky bit is applied to a directory, other users can not delete anything, even if they have full permission on the directory.

To apply the sticky bit feature to a directory, run the following command: